

Chapter 74-7

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"Dr. Zhao." Liang Shi waved her hand in front of Zhao Xuning's eyes, and only then did Zhao Xuning stop her chaotic reminiscing and come back to her senses, responding, "What is it?"

"You're asking me what's wrong?" Liang Shi asked, "What's wrong with you? You're crying."

"Was there something touching written on this letter?" Liang Shi said, "Your tears have soaked into it."

Zhao Xuning hurriedly raised her hand to wipe away the marks, but Liang Shi stopped her. "You'll tear it if you do that."

Only then did Zhao Xuning stop. She folded the paper, put it back into the envelope, turned around and wiped her tears, saying softly, "I'm fine."

Liang Shi suddenly asked, "How many years did you date your girlfriend?"

Zhao Xuning clutched that letter tightly in her hand. "Six years."

Four years of university, two years while studying abroad. In her third year abroad, Shen Hui got pregnant, had a miscarriage, and also misunderstood that she had cheated. Shen Hui ended her studies early and was taken back to the country by her family.

It was only at the hospital that she learned Shen Hui wasn't just some ordinary girl—she was the second young miss of the Shen family.

That day, Shen Hui lay on the bed as if all her vitality had been drained away.

Zhao Xuning apologized endlessly, but it was all in vain.

Just like that, they broke up.

After that, she never saw Shen Hui again, and she knew Shen Hui would never forgive her.

Shen Hui had an extremely severe obsession with purity in relationships—she was someone who would never give others a second chance.

What the truth of that night actually was no longer mattered.

What mattered was that Shen Hui saw her tangled in bed with another woman, even though nothing substantial had happened that day.

Zhao Xuning regretted countless times—why hadn't she been more vigilant?

Why did she fall into someone else's trap?

Her last year abroad was spent in a daze, drowning her sorrows in alcohol every day in the apartment they had rented, getting completely drunk.

It wasn't until close to her return to the country that she managed to pull herself together.

The past couldn't be revisited—once remembered, it was heart-piercing, bone-eroding pain.

After saying the words "six years," Zhao Xuning finally realized just how many days she and Shen Hui had spent together.

In all her lonely days, it was Shen Hui who had kept her company.

"Couldn't make it past the seven-year itch, huh." ¹ Liang Shi sighed with emotion. "You two must have been very happy once."

Zhao Xuning nodded sluggishly. "Yes."

After saying this, Zhao Xuning pressed her lips together. "Sorry, this..."

"I won't rent this apartment." Liang Shi spoke before her. "If we moved in, wouldn't we be overwriting the beautiful memories you two once had?"

Zhao Xuning took a deep breath. "Sorry."

"What's there to be sorry about?" Liang Shi patted her shoulder. "You being willing to lend me an apartment is already like sending charcoal in snowy weather, ² okay? Now that you can't rent it out, that's the most normal thing in the world."

Zhao Xuning said, "The 10th floor of this building is also mine. If you don't mind it being small, you can live there."

Liang Shi: "?"

"Dr. Zhao, are you like a cunning rabbit with three burrows?" ³ Liang Shi joked to ease the awkward atmosphere.

Zhao Xuning smiled lightly. "I just happened to see someone selling it, thought the price was right so I bought it. Because Shen Hui's birthday is in October, and she really liked this residential complex."

"Hey." Liang Shi suddenly thought of something. "Between you and Shen Hui, who's older?"

"She's two years older than me." Zhao Xuning said.

"Then how old are you?" Liang Shi followed up.

Zhao Xuning: "Twenty-five."

Liang Shi: ".....???"

Liang Shi was stunned, feeling like she hadn't heard clearly. "What did you say?"

Zhao Xuning: ".....Twenty-five."

"We're the same age?" Liang Shi asked in astonishment.

"Obviously." Zhao Xuning rolled her eyes. "We were in the same class in elementary school."

"But the thing is, I..." Liang Shi was a bit incoherent. "This body—she only graduated a few years ago. You... why are you already a doctor?"

"I skipped grades." Zhao Xuning said as if it were nothing. "Skipped two grades in middle school, one grade in high school."

Liang Shi: "....."

Alright.

The world of geniuses was always different from ordinary people.

Zhao Xuning was twenty-five this year and had already dated Shen Hui for six years—didn't that mean she had started dating Shen Hui right when she became an adult?

It really was hard to forget.

"Then why don't you and Shen Hui get back together?" Liang Shi asked. "You obviously still love her."

"She doesn't love me anymore." Zhao Xuning said.

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi, who had been single since birth, didn't know how to comfort Zhao Xuning either. She could only let her adjust her emotions on her own. Then they went downstairs to look at Zhao Xuning's apartment on the tenth floor.

That apartment had a strong minimalist style.⁴ After the renovation was completed, not a single day had anyone lived in it—Zhao Xuning had purely bought it just to look at.

However, this one was indeed much smaller than the one upstairs—just over eighty square meters, two bedrooms and one living room, one kitchen and one bathroom.

No extra study room.

But fortunately, it was still a river-view apartment. Liang Shi even asked Zhao Xuning how much this apartment cost.

Zhao Xuning said over four million.

Liang Shi silently calculated in her head—the housing price here was over forty thousand per square meter.

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That was still acceptable.

Liang Shi planned that once she got used to living here, she would buy a slightly bigger apartment in this residential complex in the future.

Footnotes:

¹ "七年之癢" (qī nián zhī yǎng) - The "seven-year itch," a concept referring to the idea that happiness in a relationship declines after around seven years of marriage or being together, when couples may feel restless or dissatisfied.

² "雪中送炭" (xuě zhōng sòng tàn) - Literally "sending charcoal in snowy weather." A Chinese idiom meaning to provide help when someone desperately needs it, like giving warmth to someone freezing in the snow.

³ "狡兔三窟" (jiǎo tù sān kū) - Literally "a cunning rabbit has three burrows." A Chinese idiom meaning a clever person always has multiple backup plans or escape routes. Here, Liang Shi is teasing Zhao Xuning for owning multiple properties.

⁴ "性冷淡風" (xìng lěngdàn fēng) - Literally "sexually cold/frigid style." Despite the literal meaning, this is actually a popular Chinese internet term for minimalist aesthetic design—characterized by neutral colors, clean lines, and simple, uncluttered spaces. The term was borrowed from fashion and interior design trends.